



CAMBRIDGE-INDIA FRONTIER TECHNOLOGY NETWORK

Inaugural Roundtable · Launching UK-India collaboration in frontier technologies ahead of the UK-India Free Trade Agreement

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Two Trajectories

Global Frontier

SpaceX and Anthropic alone have quadrupled in combined value on their way to trillion-dollar public listings — capital compounding relentlessly into frontier AI and deeptech.

Indian Markets

Indian equities have been among the weakest performing major markets in the same window — despite a talent base and engineering depth that rivals anyone's.

We have neither frontier models nor East Asian manufacturing scale. But the decade ahead belongs to AI and deeptech — the question is whether India shapes it, or watches it. Today's roundtable, and the FTA now in force, are one answer.

The Diagnosis: Success That Softened Us

~\$600B

capital RETURNED by Indian IT services to investors
in the last decade (₹5–7 lakh crore)

\$10–20B

total INVESTED in Indian AI & deeptech in the same
period — even counting liberal 'AI-washing'

Safe ROI metrics are driving into a storm looking in the rear-view mirror. Bridging that gap needs more than domestic capital — it needs pipelines to research depth and patient capital of the kind Cambridge and UK partners bring.

Today's Frontier: Three Tracks



AI as Digital Public Infrastructure

India's DPI model — Aadhaar-scale rails — as a template for AI deployed at population scale, not just enterprise scale



Space Data Centres & Orbital Compute

Heat rejection, not processing power, is the binding constraint on AI in orbit — ISRO-grade thermal engineering meets UK space capital



Genomics & Frugal Health

Applying India's frugal-innovation discipline to genomics and healthcare — cost curves the UK life-sciences ecosystem is watching closely

The Missing Glue: A Bilateral Sangam



Cambridge & Indian Academia

Research rigour — Judge Business School, CFI, and Indian institutions (IISER, IIT) building the science base together



Founders & Deeptech Teams

India's engineering depth — ISRO-grade thermal systems, AI compute, genomics — meeting UK commercial and technical partners



Capital: A3, EPOCH & UK Partners

Patient capital on both sides of the FTA corridor, channelled into knowledge pipelines rather than short-cycle returns

Like the invisible Saraswati at the sangam of Prayagraj — a standing network is the unseen third stream that turns occasional goodwill into a durable confluence.



Launching the Network

From a single roundtable to a standing UK-India collaboration platform

- 1 Launch of the Cambridge-India Frontier Technology Network
- 2 Quarterly UK-India collaboration meetings
- 3 Knowledge, capital and research pipelines
- 4 Release of the discussion paper

"India @ AI & Deeptech Crossroads" — co-authored by Sanjay Phadke & Dr. Jaideep Prabhu